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EDU705 Highlighted Handouts BY PIN2 and MUHAMMAD (MAS All Rounder)

Lesson No. 1

Purpose and Main Components of a Thesis

Topic 1: Purpose of the Thesis

To enable students to develop:

- deeper knowledge
- understanding
- capabilities

mcq Overall goal is for student to display knowledge and capacity to:

- contribute to research and development work
- deal with complex theoretical issues
- to plan and use adequate methods and evaluate

Thesis at the end of the programme offers the opportunity to:

- delve deeply into
- and synthesize acquired knowledge

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Topic 2: Writing Style and Audience

Audience and Purpose

Context of writing

Range of audience

Authority readers or 'critics'

Primary Audience (IMP Q. Primary Effect. How does it affect the audience)

mcq - Scholarly community

Real and imagined

Internalize audience

Supportive ○

Hostile

○ Adversarial

Secondary Audience

External examiners

Representative of scholarly community

Immediate Audience

Supervisor

Highly influential

'Ideal Reader'

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Topic 3: Order and Component of Thesis (L.Q)

Title page

Statement of originality/ copyright page

a) Dedication

b) Acknowledgements

Abstract

Table of Contents

List of :
- Tables
- Figures/ illustrations

List of Abbreviations

Chapters

- Introduction
- Literature Review
- Methodology
- Results
- Discussion
- Conclusion

References

Appendices

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Topic 4: Title

Title should SUMMARIZE the main idea:

- be concise
- highlight key variables
- full explanatory

Title should not have abbreviations.

Function:

- inform
- statement of content (data based)

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Topic 5: Statement of Originality; Dedication and Acknowledgement

(IMP)

- Statement of Originality: / (Copy right) Type text here

  appears after the title page
  - may differ in form
  - declares that the work is your own

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Dedications, Acknowledgements
- dedication optional
- acknowledgements on a separate page
- no heading required

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Dedications: a short statement of tribute

Acknowledgements: statement of gratitude and recognition

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Topic 6: Table of Contents and Appendices

Provide:

Any outline of you thesis

Titles of all chapters – Subtitles: sections

Hierarchy

Page numbers

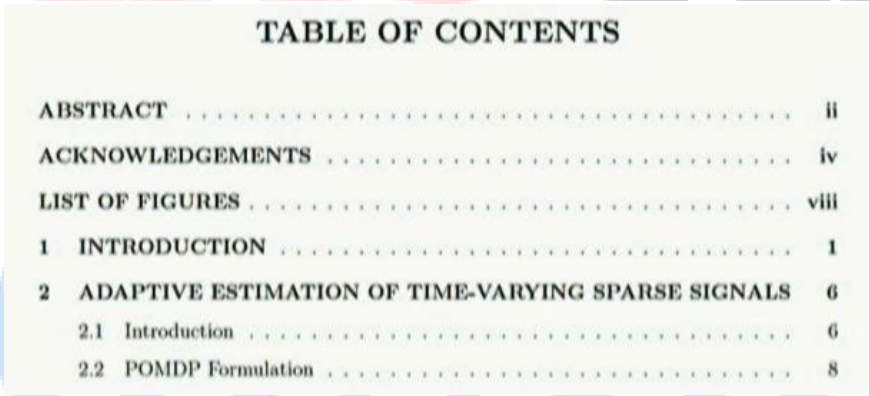


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2.1 Introduction 6
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What to include:

Important supplemental material

Some interview transcripts

Pictures

Consent forms

Ethical clearances

Purpose:

Validate the research process

Provide important information that cannot be included

Overcome the limitations of word restriction

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Lesson No. 2

Appendices and Footnotes

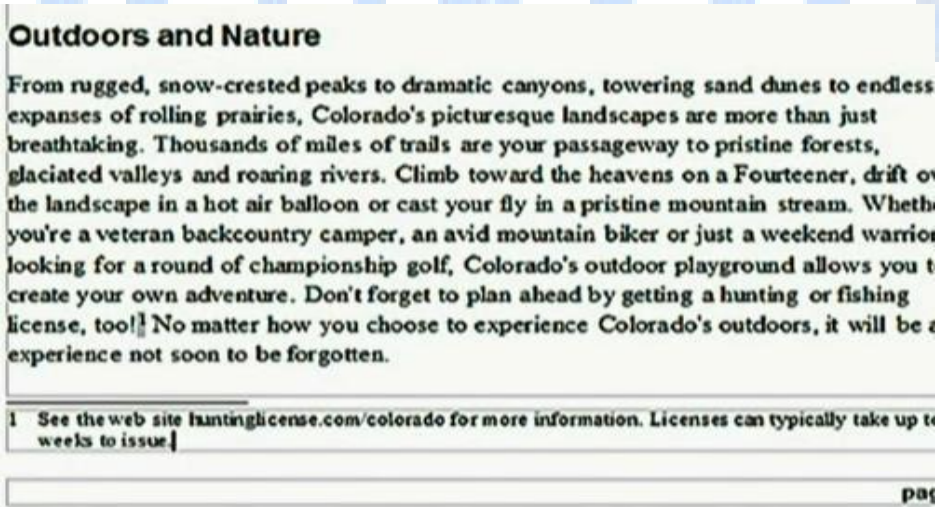
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Topic 7: Footnotes and Endnotes

Footnotes

Appear at the bottom of the page

- Separated from the text
- Single-spaced
- Double-spaced line between each note



Outdoors and Nature

From rugged, snow-crested peaks to dramatic canyons, towering sand dunes to endless expanses of rolling prairies, Colorado's picturesque landscapes are more than just breathtaking. Thousands of miles of trails are your passageway to pristine forests, glaciated valleys and roaring rivers. Climb toward the heavens on a Fourteener, drift o the landscape in a hot air balloon or cast your fly in a pristine mountain stream. Wheth you're a veteran backcountry camper, an avid mountain biker or just a weekend warrio looking for a round of championship golf, Colorado's outdoor playground allows you t create your own adventure. Don't forget to plan ahead by getting a hunting or fishing license, too![1] No matter how you choose to experience Colorado's outdoors, it will be a experience not soon to be forgotten.

1 See the web site huntinglicense.com/colorado for more information. Licenses can typically take up t weeks to issue.

- Purpose of the Footnotes
  - Additional information
  - Comment
  - Source
  - Adapted of ideas
  -
  -

A Footnote should:

- Convey one idea at a time
  - Be concise
  - Be inserted with the use of computer software-numbering options

(IMP) • Difference between Endnote and Footnote:

- Endnotes appear at the end of each chapter or at the end of a thesis

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- Choice depends on the discipline
- Footnotes should be used sparingly *(economically, carefully, in moderation)*

Topic 8: Abstract

It is the gist of your study and functions to provide an overview of your work.

mcq • Correctly reflect the purpose and content

It should be accurate:

Not include any information that is not in the text

Not leave out important details – comparison with headings

Replication of theory or methods to be mentioned

It should be non-evaluative:

Avoid comments – reports

It should be coherent and readable:

Clear statements

Verbs instead of noun equivalents

- Example: investigation of – investigate

It should be concise:

Brief – word limit

Each sentence important

Specific words

Avoid lengthy explanations

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Topic 9: Abstract: Functions

Aims to provide:

- A snapshot of thesis
- Key considerations of the thesis regarding:
  - Focus
  - Methodology
  - Findings
  - Contribution

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Functions of Thesis Abstract are to give an overview of:

- Aim of the study
- Background and context of the study
- Research design and Methodology ○ Methods
  - ○ Sampling
  - ○ Site
- Key findings
- The contribution of the study to the field of knowledge

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Topic 10: Abstract: Content and Structure

Structure of an Abstract: (L.Q. Features of Abstract)

- Introduction
- Purpose
- Method
- Product/ Results
- Conclusion

Introduction:

- Significance of the issue
- Background
- Identify research gap

Purpose:

- Identify aims/ intentions
- Questions/ hypotheses

Research Methods/ Design:

Overall approach mcq

- Key aspects – sampling – instruments
- Data sources
- Data analysis

Product/ Results

- Key findings

mcq ***Conclusion***

- Significance of research
- Implications/ arguments for application

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Topic 11: Analysis of a Sample Abstract: Pattern

Abstract

The role of the first language (L1) in second language (L2) learning needs careful consideration in bilingual settings. Seen as a part of learners' identity and schemata, the positive role of L1 has been stressed by many researchers. However, in Pakistan, any role of L1 in L2 learning is dismissed even before being considered, and hardly raised in teacher training programmes. With stress on communicative skills development, L1 is officially dismissed from L2 classrooms. The complexity increases in ESP courses dealing with adult learners, their fossilized errors, shortage of time and other pressing academic needs. This calls for an inquiry into more effective and efficient means of teaching L2, one of which may be to exploit the skills and knowledge of L1, the learners already possess. The valuable role of L1 is emphasized by sociocultural theory of language acquisition and pedagogical theory of Language Awareness but before these theories can be fruitfully utilized at a pedagogical level, the perceptions of teachers and learners regarding the issue have to be investigated.

This study explores the role of L1 in L2 learning from the perspective of the perceptions of teachers and learners. This is based on the assumption that teachers an learners possess valuable first hand knowledge about the teaching/ learning situation, which comprises complex networks of beliefs, assumptions and background knowledge. These perceptions affect their practices and influence teaching/ learning outcomes and an exploration of these perceptions provides valuable insights into the teaching/ learning situation. To achieve a comprehensive understanding of the issue, the current study goes beyond the cognitive and also attempts to discover the sources and influences that shape these perceptions. By conjoining the cognitive and social dimensions it brings a holistic understanding to the important issue of the role of L1 in L2 learning that is of immediate relevance to learners, practitioners and policy makers.

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Missing aspects:

Sample

Methodology

Key findings

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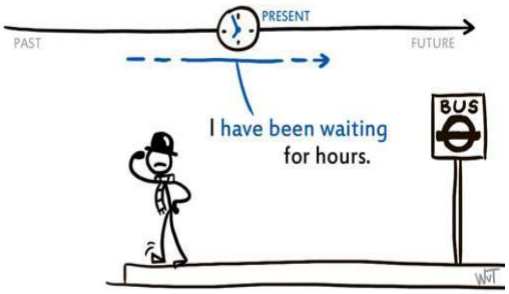
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Topic 12: Key Linguistic Feature of an Abstract:

Tense mcq Different Tenses convey different meaning:

Highly important feature

0



Present Perfect tense: continuity up to present

Example: This “has been” explored.

Appropriate for introduction – previous work in the field

Simple Present: reference to the **immediate** present

The aspect that “remains” unexplored is:

- Identifying a gap
- Purpose
- Findings generalizability

Simple Past to report a completed action:

Example: The study used a multiple case=study design. The sample included….

For: reporting methodology.

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Lesson No. 3

Abstract Writing

Topic 13: Questions Related to Abstract Writing

How long should it be?

Varies: Most abstracts are confined to 350-500 words

mcq

Best time to write an Abstract:

- At the end
- A draft in the beginning

Varies – but the main structural parts should be there Should all results be presented?

Key results must be presented – others are optional but this should not be longends

How specific should one be while referring to implications?

Depends on individual preference but must not be:

Too stretched

An over-statement or tall claims

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IMP **Topic 14: Introduction Chapter in a Thesis** mcq/ L.Q

Introduction:

The opening chapter of the thesis

- Extremely important
- Shorter and at the forefront

Should:

- Give an overview of the work
- Simple and clear without too much complex arguments

It involves consideration of several steps.

Topic 15: Functions of the Introduction Chapter mcq

The Introduction of the thesis functions to present:

1. The problem and its significance

2. Brief overview of what is known from literature

Gap in the body of knowledge

Explanation of how you want to address this gap – aims

Outline of your plan of investigation

Contribution of your work

An outline of the content and structure of your thesis

Key constructs

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Topic 16: Introduction: Content and Structure

Establish a Research Territory

Establish a Niche

Occupy the Niche

Topic 17: Introduction: Establishing a Research Territory

Explain the extent to which it is:

significant

central

interesting

problematic

or relevant

Provide background research about the relevant questions that have been raised

Introduce and briefly review aspects of previous relevant research to answer

Topic 18: Indicating a Gap/ Niche (M.IMP)

Establish a Niche:

- Indicate gaps in previous research

mcq

- Raise a question about previous research
- Identify problem or need
- Extend previous knowledge

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Lesson No. 4

Occupy the Niche/ Gap

Topic 19: Occupy the Niche/ Gap

(IMP LQ. How do researchers occupy niche/ gap?)

Establish a Niche:

- Indicate gaps in previous research
- Raise a question about previous research
- Identify problem or need
- Extend previous knowledge

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Topic 20: Statement of the Problem and the Context

SECTION I

1. THE STUDY AND ITS CONTEXT

In Pakistan, English is taught as second language (L2) and Urdu as first (L1).[1] In th elite educational institutions, English is also the medium of instruction while in government institutions, accessible to a vast majority of population, it is Urdu (L1). However, English assumes a critical role in higher education when it becomes the sole language of subject specific content. Ironically, it is here that a majority of the learners realize the futility of their exam-oriented, literature based and grammar focused English language study, hinged on an obsolete curriculum and poor methodology. At the threshold of their career and with years of L2 instruction behi them, they still find themselves inadequately equipped to grasp the complex, intric language of their professional study.

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1. 2. Statement of the problem

At [redacted] exclusive use of English in L2 classrooms is stressed, though the teachers and learners find themselves compelled to use L1 for different reasons. This 'unofficial' use of L1, though minimal and forced by necessity triggers a strong sense of 'guilt' arising from the apprehension that precious L2 practice and input time has been wasted. The best the teachers can manage is to attempt to restrict themselves to L2 while trying desperately to repress learners' use of L1. Ironically, at times learning is the price to be paid for this attempted 'virtual use' of L2 (Macaro, 1997), leading to different problems.

Firstly, though the stress on L2, gradually gives learners the confidence to use it, this stays punctuated with errors.[1] Secondly, they hardly move beyond passive reception

The result is that the learners hardly make the desired progress in their L2 skills[2] and at times even after the completion of their 3-year course.

There is no researched evidence that 'virtual' use of L2 can actually help in learning L2 and ensure 'creative use of language'[3] (Macaro,1997). Studies report high degree

It is critical that instead of making them 'remember'[5] the language to respond to some standard situations, learners are made autonomous by assisting them to develop strategies for participating in the unpredictable linguistic interaction of a dynamic world. However, this autonomy is not possible without 'teacher autonomy' (Macaro, 2001). The current study draws attention to the strong need of acknowledging the experience of teachers and learners, understanding the issue from their perspective and revisiting the role of L1 in L2 learning.

mcq A research problem is a statement about an area of concern, a condition to be improved upon, a difficulty to be eliminated, or a troubling question that exists in scholarly literature, in theory, or in practice that points to the need for meaningful understanding and deliberate investigation. A research problem does not state how to do something, offer a vague or broad proposition, or present a value question.

The purpose of a problem statement is to:

Introduce the reader to the importance of the topic being studied. The reader is oriented to the significance of the study and the research questions or hypotheses to follow.

Place the problem into a particular context that defines the parameters of what is to be investigated.

Provide the framework for reporting the results and indicates what is probably necessary to conduct the study and explain how the findings will present this information.

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Topic 21: Aims of the Study

The primary focus of the research project

Delimitation

Clear and concise statements

It determines methods and scope of the study

Can be in a separate section after the indication or gap or appear in a separate paragraph

The aim of the study was to…

Explore...

Gain insight into the processes…

Topic 22: Clarification of Key Constructs

What are Key Constructs?

Key words appearing in your research question

Key variables

Constructs because they are socially constructed:

Different meanings assigned to the same term or construct
Example: Does education lead to women empowerment?

Education
Empowerment

2. CLARIFICATION OF CONCEPTS

A brief introduction of the key terms operationalized in the study would be important here before further discussion:

L1 has been considered as 'first language', 'native language', 'mother tongue', 'prima language', and 'stronger language'(Stern, 1983: 9). It is also used to indicate 'historica first' or language learnt informally. In this study, L1 is taken to mean Urdu 'primary language' (p.10), and the national language of Pakistan, which is the native language o most of the learners but that might not always be the case.

L2 is seen synonymous to 'non-native language', 'foreign language', and 'weaker language' (Stern, 1983: 9). The term also signals availability of a prior language and learning in formal settings. In this study L2 refers to English.

Role of L1 in L2 learning may be positive, negative, instructional, pedagogical, acquisitional, explicit, implicit, conscious, subconscious, and may operate in 'social', 'power', 'affective', 'cognitive', or 'performance domains' (James & Garett, 1992).

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Topic 23: Organization of the Thesis

(Q. note on orgaization thesis)

Introduction to the organization of your thesis:

Appears towards the end of the chapter

Signposting *(marking, labeling, pointing out)*

The thesis is divided into seven chapters. The **first** introduces the context and concern of the study, and clarifies key constructs operationalized; the **second** briefly reviews relevant literature, indicates the gap and outlines the conceptual framework of the study. The **third** presents the research questions and research design, followed by a discussion of some methodological issues. The **fourth** and **fifth** chapters share analysis of data; the **sixth** presents a discussion of key themes, and the **seventh chapter** concludes by providing implications of the study, its limitations, its significance and directions for future research.

Can choose to add details:

> **Example**: "Chapter 3 depicts the methodological approach of the study. In order to enrich the study multi-method design was adopted. It is contended that such a design is advantageous"

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Topic 24: Key Linguistic Features in Establishing Significance of the Study

Linguistic Features:

When describing the importance of the problem, use ***present tense*** and the ***present perfect tense***.

Present	Present Perfect
Is/ are	Has, have
Do/ does	

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Examples:

The study addresses the current gap in literature….

The significance of the current study lies in….

Theoretical perspectives and existing research use:

Present perfect (some researchers *have advocated*….)

The research in this area has mainly focused on….

Can also use present tense – when presenting theoretical framework….

The simple *past tense* (MacIntyre et al. *examined*….)

When referring to a completed study

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Lesson No. 5

Key Linguistic Features in Indicating the Gap

Topic 25: Key Linguistic Features in Indicating the Gap

Establishing a niche: When identifying a gap in available research, use:

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- Present perfect tense
- And/ or the present simple tense

It describes what has not been investigated up to the present point in time.

Example: "While a number of studies related to leadership in public sector education have been undertaken, the aspect of gender remains ignored".

Topic 26: Key Linguistic Features in Occupying the Gap in the Introduction

Aims: use simple present

Example:

The primary purpose of the study is to explore….

The current study contributes….

Occupying the niche:

mcq • Explaining your aims as goals that have been achieved, as methodology use past simple tense

Example: The study involved eight international students….

Topic 27: Active vs. Passive Voice Use

Which one to choose?

No hard and fast rule

Matter of choice

Whether one wants to give prominence to the object of the sentence or the subject

Use of Passive Voice:

mcq • To maintain anonymity of the subject

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To suggest something as an established fact

Examples: - Gaps in previous research *are* subsequently *identified*….

- Key findings from an analysis of the research data *are presented* in chapter 4

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Topic 28: Key Linguistic Features: Adjectives and Pronouns

Use of Adjectives:

To emphasize the importance or centrality of research territory
Example: A *dominant* feature of leadership has been…

Also when identifying the gap

Example: Research is unclear, ambiguous…

First Person Pronoun:

Opinions vary about using 'I' and 'we' in academic texts

Some believe it as being too personal

Use of I/ We:

Active voice encouraged – less wordy

We – where reader and writer are implied

Vary the style

Another option – “This chapter discusses that….”

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Topic 29: Language Use in Making Comparisons

A large range of way of expressing comparisons are available

Needed when identifying a gap – vary

Verbs:

disregard

fail to consider

ignore

is limited to

misinterpret

neglects to consider

overestimates

underestimates, etc.

Adjectives:

Controversial

Incomplete

Inconclusive

Misguided

Questionable

Unconvincing

Unsatisfactory, etc.

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Noun Phrases:

Little information

None of these studies

Passive Forms:

It remains unclear that

It would be of interest to

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Topic 30: Introduction: Questions Answered

How long should the introduction be?

If written as a separate chapter, it may take 5-10 pages

Must not be too long

Should introduction include references?

Extensive referencing is not a norm

Should it be written before other chapters?

A draft may be written at the beginning

Will be drafted many times and finalized in the end.

To what extent should terms and constructs be defined in Introduction?

Helpful to present key constructs to allow the examiner to understand the frame of reference

Would the research question come in the Introduction?

Background/ Context

Statement of the problem

Aims and objectives

Research questions

Key constructs

Thesis structure

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Lesson No. 6

Literature Review

Topic 31: Literature Review

(IMP L.Q Write detailed note on Literature review?)

First draft is usually written during the preparation of thesis proposal

- Then expand before deciding methodology
- Sections of literature review will be revised with new material being added and some existing possibly being removed
- This revision process may continue up to the point one finishes the discussion of findings

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Topic 32: Literature Review: Functions

To provide in-depth account of background literature

To provide an 'argument' or justification for the study

review of non-research literature that summarizes and synthesizes background and contextual information

- Review of theoretical perspectives
- Review of relevant research literature
- A critique
- Gap identification in this knowledge and research
- A rationale justifying why the gap was important

It explains how literature provided:

- a focus for research question
- guidelines for an appropriate methodology and design

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Topic 33: Content and Structure: Organization Options

Content of Review:

comprises series of themes/ topic units

more than a summary of material

includes critique

identifies arguments and controversies

It weighs up the value of theories, ideas, claims, research designs, methods and conclusions

It identifies gaps or shortcomings

It provides rationale for research focus

Organization Options:

The themes and topics of the review

The research questions being addressed

The variables

Chronological presentation of literature

A combination of these options

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Topic 34: Body of the Literature Review

Determining themes/ topics that will be included in review:

1. Keep a record/ summary of relevant literature

Categorize whether or not it is: ○ directly relevant

○ possibly relevant
○ not relevant

○ Year-recent

Authors:	Aslam 2005	Rahman, 2006	Bourdieu, 1990	
Focus				
Research design				
Participant/context				
Site				
Data collection				
Key findings				
Limitations				

Develop mind-map of key themes/ topics

Identify relationships

Mark the hierarchy

Arguments and counter-arguments

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Topic 35: Body of the Literature Review: Structure

Constructing a Thematic Unit:

- Establish background of relevant knowledge
- Create research gap
- Announce how will you occupy the gap in research

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Establishing relevant background

- Present knowledge – statement – theories
- Significance of the topic/ theme
- Presentation of research evidence

Indicating a research gap

- Critique
- Provide research evidence to support critique
- Indicate relevance
- Rationalize the new perspective or research

Announce how your research will fill the gap

- Provide aim of the study

Research design or conceptual map

Key constructs

Research questions

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Topic 36: Organizing a Literature Review

IMP Q. How is literature review is organized?

- Discuss from ***General to Specific*** mcq

Discuss key themes

Then synthesize *(blend, combine, join)*

Research-gap

Conceptual map of your study

Develop and outline

Different sections

Decide the best way to persuade the reader to agree

OVER VIEW OF RELEVANT LITERATURE 7
SECTION I 7
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Lesson No. 7

Reporting Research



Topic 37: Reporting Research

Frequently Presented Details:

Author(s) and date

Focus of study – aim or purpose

Sample size and setting/ location

Example: Evans (1988) explored the perceptions of a hundred students in Australia regarding most important leadership qualities in an attempt to identify…..

Key findings

Discussion

Example: The results indicated that the qualities of a leader perceived by the students were culturally specific…

f. Comparison with other studies

Example: This finding also corresponded with that of another comparative study….

Topic 38: Summarizing Key Elements of Literature Review

The body of the review:

Provides understanding of relevant literature

Informs about the known and unknown areas of knowledge

Identifies gaps/ shortcomings in theoretical arguments, revels further thinking

Tells how the project aims to investigate those gaps and why

Identifies and justifies the research niche, and methodology

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Topic 39: Conclusion of the Literature Review

Conclusion starts with **Summary** of the key claims - involving an evaluation

Identifies gaps – incorporates different moves mentioned earlier

Announces key elements of the project

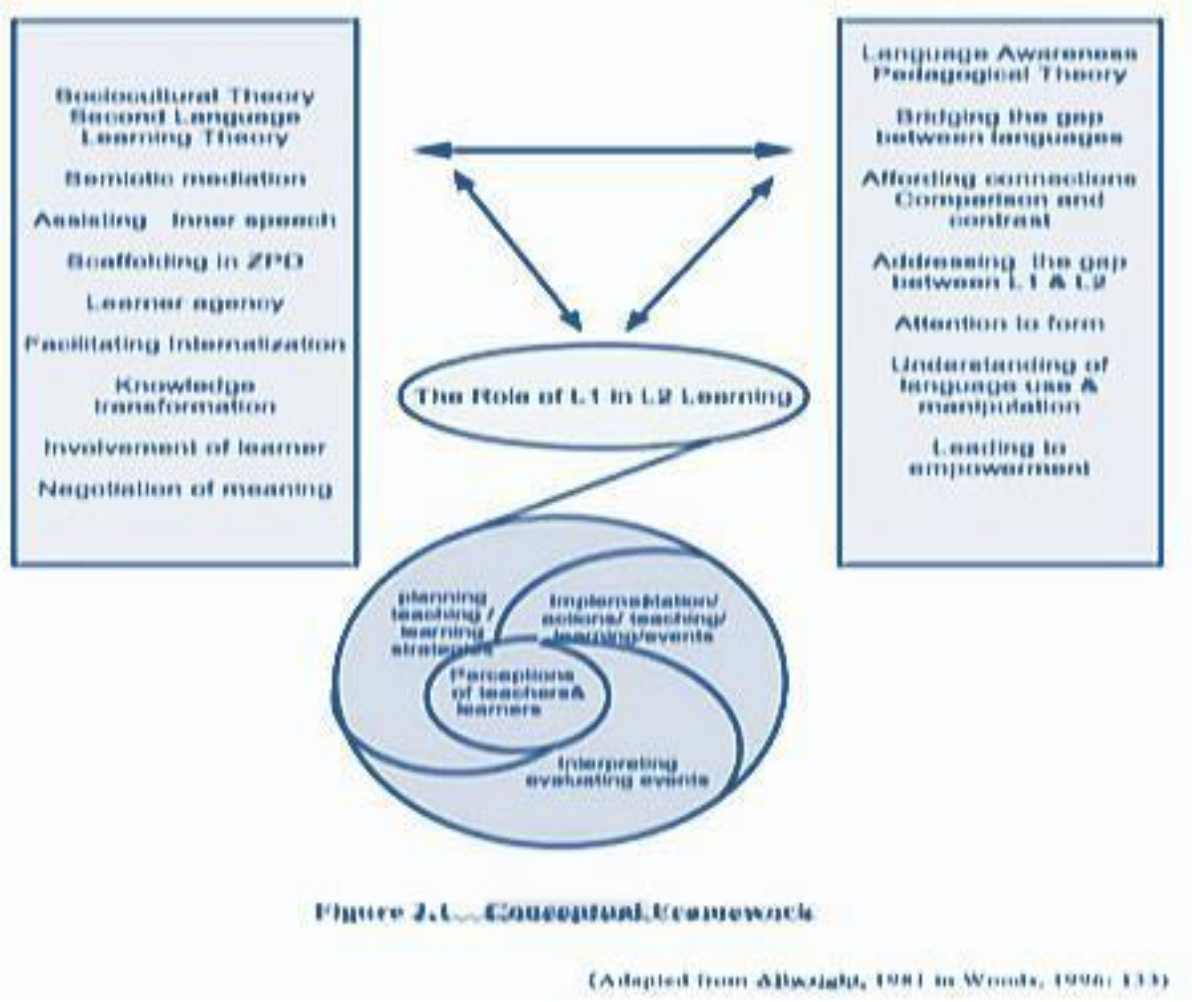


Figure 2.1 Conceptual framework

(Adapted from Allwright, 1981 in Woods, 1996: 133)

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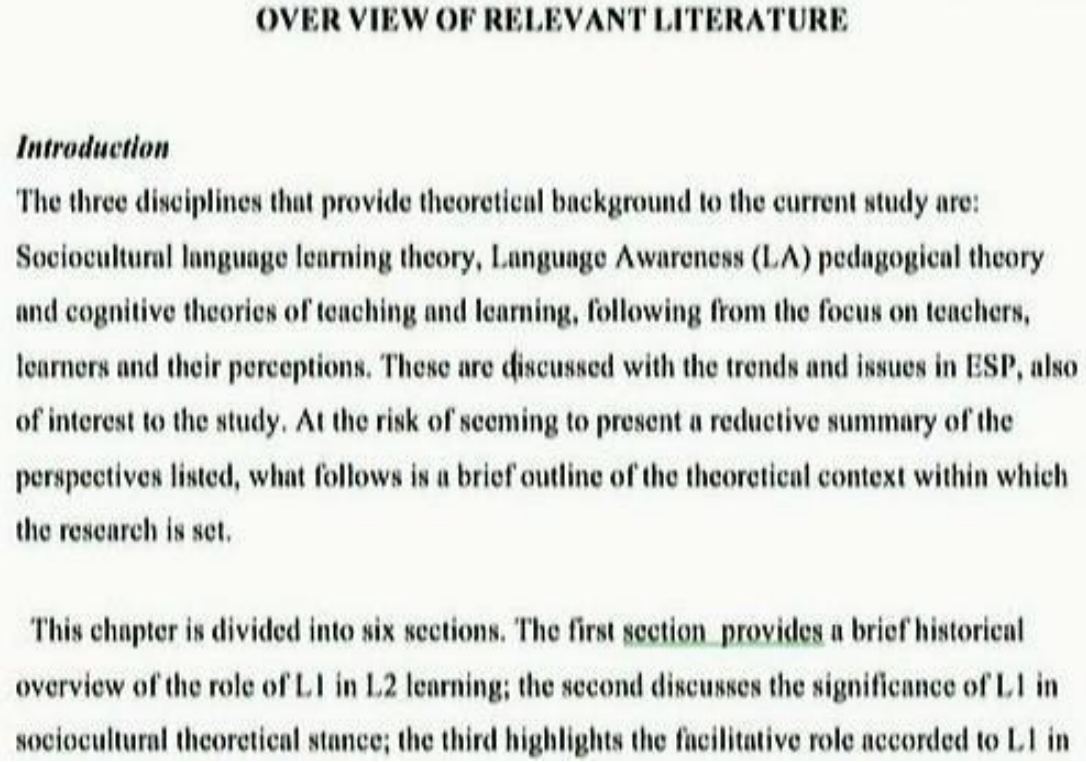
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Topic 40: Introduction to the Literature Review Chapter

- Placed before the body of review mcq
- Written in the last

mcq **Primary Function of Introduction**:

- To give an overview of themes and topics
- Often referred to as "advance organizer"
- An effective Introduction makes explicit connections between various units/ sections



OVER VIEW OF RELEVANT LITERATURE

Introduction

The three disciplines that provide theoretical background to the current study are: Sociocultural language learning theory, Language Awareness (LA) pedagogical theory and cognitive theories of teaching and learning, following from the focus on teachers, learners and their perceptions. These are discussed with the trends and issues in ESP, also of interest to the study. At the risk of seeming to present a reductive summary of the perspectives listed, what follows is a brief outline of the theoretical context within which the research is set.

This chapter is divided into six sections. The first section provides a brief historical overview of the role of L1 in L2 learning; the second discusses the significance of L1 in sociocultural theoretical stance; the third highlights the facilitative role accorded to L1 in

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Topic 41: Paraphrasing and Coherence

Argument is to explain:

The context of the study

why is it worth doing

Large number of studies mentioned but the most relevant discussed in detail

Summarizing requires paraphrasing

In recognition of the significance of L1, many methodologists endorse the use of L1 in L2 classrooms and it is argued that many language teachers intuitively use L1 to ensure 'comprehension and meaningful involvement' of the learners as they code switch, translate or plan bilingual input in their lessons (Romero & Parrino, 1994: 1). Bartelt (1992) emphasizes the need for L1 proceduralized knowledge to fill gaps in L2 declarative knowledge and L1 has been stressed as an important resource for exploitation in L2 learning (Jacobson, 1981; Jones & Ghuman, 1995; Anton & Di Camilla, 1999; Atkinson, 1987). This sociocultural theory and LA pedagogy accord a significant facilitative role to L1 that has direct implications for ESP.

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Topic 42: Synthesizing: Cohesion in Literature Review

To show similarities and differences in the issues being discussed

(Synthesizing: putting the pieces together)

Tips for synthesizing:

Cohesive links between ideas need to be clear.

Cohesive Techniques

Repetition of key words

Add connector (furthermore)

Pronoun reference (This means…)

Firstly, secondly

Contrast connections (however, nevertheless, besides)

Result connectors (therefore, consequently, thus)

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Lesson No. 8

Language Focus: Tense and Citation

Topic 43: Language Focus: Tense and Citation

Tense (Q. Tense choice in literature review OR Tense use for citation in literature review)

mcq

- Subtle and flexible choice

Mostly citation statements fall into one of the following three major patterns:

Past – Researcher Activity as Agent:

Jones (1987) investigated the causes of illiteracy

The causes of illiteracy were investigated by Jones (1987)

Present Perfect – Researcher Activity not as Agent:

The causes of illiteracy have been widely investigated (Jones 1987….)

Several researchers have studied the cause of illiteracy.

Present –No Reference to Researcher Activity:

The causes of illiteracy are complex (Jones 1987, Ferrars 1990, Hyon 1994)

Illiteracys appears to have a complex set of causes.

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Topic 44: Plagiarism

Claim over ideas and words:

Unethical

Quotes should be used in direct borrowing of words

"prioritized"

Paraphrasing

In every re-wording, summarizing, paraphrasing – acknowledge the source

Extends to Ideas

Credit where the ideas originated

Plagiarism has very strong repercussions

Self Plagiarism

Reproducing your own published work

Self reference

The point is to make sure that the work is original

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Topic 45: Reporting Literature: Approaches

Reasons for Reporting

To explain what has been reported in the literature and what has not been reported

To evaluate or critique other's work to negotiate own stance

To find support for the stance taken or findings

Approaches to Reporting

a. Central reporting

Michael (1992) concluded that the perceptions of the teachers were rooted in their learning experiences

Non-central reporting

The results appear to offer the best instrument for measuring motivation (McCroskey & Riichmond 1987)

Non-reporting

Educational leadership has its specific challenges that need to be explained with reference to context (Usman, 1993)

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Topic 46: Choice of Verb and Tense

Choice of Reporting Verb

Reveals your stance towards the published literature

One needs to be careful in selecting verb

mcq • Similar verbs can mislead the interpretation

Difference in Meanings

State and claim

Noted

Argued

Contended

Claimed

Established

Proposed

Admit

Acknowledge

Tense of Reporting Verb

Varies even within a single paragraph

Choice Reasons

Past Simple

To refer to a claim or finding

e.g. Smith (2008) revealed that…

Present Simple

to convey current state of knowledge

make generalization

to present earlier findings as accepted facts

e.g. Smith (2008) revealed that…

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Topic 47: Evaluating and Critiquing Published Research

Evaluation Questions

research issue clearly stated?

Content sufficiently explained?

Justification for research?

Research question/ hypothesis clear?

Methodical approach relevant/

Data collection methods sufficient

Are the instruments appropriate?

Variables and constructs defined?

Procedures sufficiently complete?

Analysis and its process?

Findings related to research question?

Findings relevant?

Findings sufficient?

Claims/ conclusions based on findings?

Implications drawn from the findings?

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Topic 48: Stance towards Published Research

Linguistic Strategies:

a) Hedges IMP Q. When & where hedges are used in reporting result?

- To withhold your full commitment to a statement: i.e. may; might; possibly; likely; seemed to; appeared to…

mcq b) Boosters

To reveal certainty: i.e. clearly; definitely; without doubt….

Attitude markers

Like: interestingly; surprisingly; unfortunately….

Engagement markers

Like: as you can see; you will have noted that; consider whether….

Self mentions

- To make reference to the research: I; we; my; our…

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Lesson No. 9

Reviewing the Literature: Organizing

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Topic 49: Reviewing the Literature: Organizing

Role and Purpose of Citations mcq

To acknowledge intellectual property rights of authors

To show respect to previous scholars

To give a statement greater authority

To "pay" respect

To demonstrate familiarity

A defense against plagiarism

To create a research space for the citing author

Organizing

Start with major traditional views

For the remaining views, either chronological order can be followed

Or can be presented in categories – research in the end

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Topic 50: Important Questions Answered

How long should the literature review be?

Master's thesis may have only on chapter around 5000 words

Shorter than your findings chapter

How to decide what to include and what not to include?

Ask yourself:

Which aspects of literature are related to this thesis?

Does it add anything new to what has been included already?

Should I refer to methodology literature in literature review?

That is usually presented in methodology chapter

However it may be referred to in order to explain a claim-special circumstances

If many writers have made the same claim, how many should I refer to?

Best to refer to three or four

Include the most recent and the most significant

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(IMP L.Q)

Topic 51: Methodology

(L.Q Describe methodology in detail)

Overview:

- Functions of methodology chapter
- The content
- Organization

Methodology:

- Relatively straightforward chapter to write
- Issues and processes were discussed before data collection

All it requires is:

- Attention
- Careful consideration
- Clear understanding of the aims and functions of chapter

Extremely important:

- Entry into dangerous waters
- Coherence
- Essentially a defense

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Topic 52: Methodology of a Thesis: Functions

Description and justification:

Suitability of methodical approach to the research

Choice of research design

mcq • Specific methods of data collection

mcq • Ways in which issues of validity and reliability were dealt

Data collection procedures

Data analysis procedures

mcq • Ethical concerns

Delimitation

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Topic 53: Methodology: Content and Structure

Three parts:

Introduction

Main body

Conclusion

Present the paradigm

Methodology

Describe the data collection process

Data analysis process

Conclude

Summarize and evaluate

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Topic 54: Introduction in a Methodology Chapter

The Introductory part needs to provide an:

mcq • Overview of methodological chapter and key arguments

Justification with brief reference to the literature review

Theoretical framework as applied

Key constructs if not defined earlier

Signposting

Research question if not given earlier

Maybe divided into sections

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Lesson No. 10

Methodology: Main Body

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Topic 55: Methodology: Main Body

Methodological framework:

- Paradigms and approaches
- Theoretical issues

Data collection:

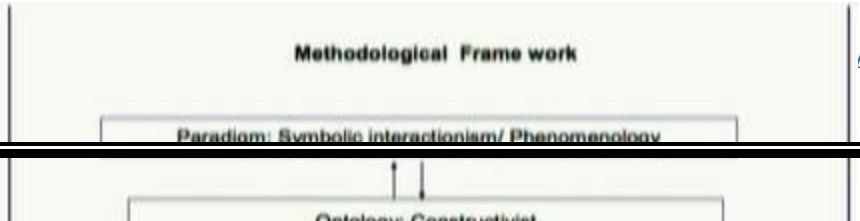
- Describing sample : Location, Size, Characteristics, Criteria

Data

- Steps and justification in data collection and analysis

Other issues

- Piloting
- Ethical concerns
- Validity and reliability



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Topic 56: Conclusion of a Methodology Chapter

Type text here

- Summarize

Justify the data analysis procedure

Evaluate

Relate to research question

No new information mcq

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Topic 57: Triangulation mcqs

Triangulation can be

Methodological

Research triangulation

Theoretical triangulation

Methodological

Data sources

Methods

Participants

Researcher

Investigation

Analysis

Theoretical

Theories

Paradigms

Triangulation must be

Discussed in detail and justified

Reflected in findings

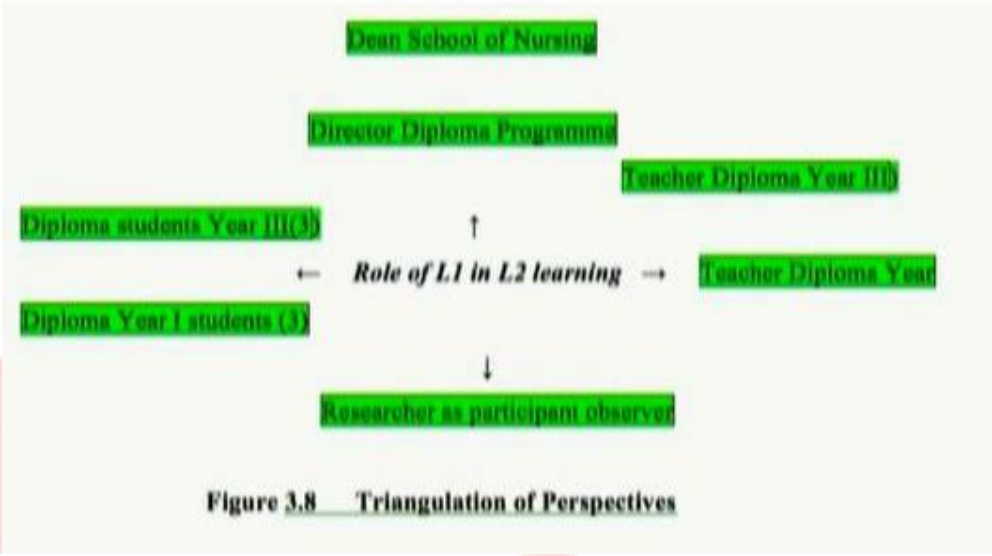


Figure 3.8 Triangulation of Perspectives

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Topic 58: Key Structural Points in Methodology Chapter

Key points

- Approach
- Basis of determining methodological approach
- Justification and procedure
- Qualitative and quantitative – methods
- Triangulation
- Integrated approach
- Procedures
- Sampling
- Piloting
- Validity and reliability
- Ethical concerns
- Detailed characteristics and data collection analysis
- Make connections
- Evaluate
- Discuss issues

CHAPTER III 23
METHODOLOGY: MAPPING THE JOURNEY 23
SECTION I 23
1. Research Questions 23
SECTION II 24
2. Methodological Issues & Woods's Study (1996) 24
SECTION III 25
3. Methodological Framework 25
3.1 Paradigms: Phenomenology & Symbolic Interactionism 26
3.2 Methodology: Qualitative 27
3.3 Research design: Ethno-cognitive Case study 28

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SECTION IV 31
4. Data collection 31
4.1 Pilot study 33
4.2 Methods 34
SECTION V 41
5. Method of data analysis 41
5.1 Transcription 42
5.2 Procedure of analysis 43
SECTION VI 49
6.1 Validity & Reliability 49
6.2 Ethical Issues 51

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Topic 59: Data Collection Procedures

Explain and justify choices regarding:

- Sampling
- Sites
- Processes and issues
- Pilot study
- Instrument development

mcq Sampling criteria

- Background of participants: gender, age, ethnic

group Explain and justify

- Size
- Location
- Context
- Characteristics

Pilot study

- Processes and issues
- Positioning of self (optional)

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Topic 60: Instruments

Data collection instruments / methods

Justify the choice of instrument

Data collection instruments include:

Observations

Questionnaires

Interviews

Documentary/ video analysis

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Lesson No. 11

Topic 61: Data Collection

Identify and outline stages

Justification of steps

Representations of procedures

Interview Example:

Multistage sampling was used in the process

Firstly class observation were carried to identify participants' attitudes

Secondly these students were chosen for interview

Topic 62: Data Analysis

Steps in analytical process

Levels of details and illustration

Basis on which data analysis methods were chosen

Decision taken when deciding to represent analytical data

Topic 63: Data Reliability

Importance for

Study deign

Data collection

Analysis procedures

Data reliability measure

--Data collection procedures is

Consistent

Accuracy

--To achieve data reliability

Triangulation approach

For example

Methods of interviews to ensure the reliability

Structured interview and same interviewer

Audio-tapes

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Pilot study to ensure the reliability of instrument

Topic 64: Issues of Data validity (L.Q Thesis validity)

Are the instruments measuring what they claim to measure?

Is the data collection process is valid?

Content validity of questionnaires

Item analysis

Construct validity

Use of triangulation

Language

Topic 65: Ethical Concerns (L.Q Researchers describe the Ethical Concern)

Privacy and confidentiality must be respected through research process specially like name

Aims of research and nature of study should be explained clearly to the participants

Participants' right to withdraw form study anytime should be respected

Written consent (Appendix)

Details of ethical issues and how they were dealt with

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Lesson No.12

Topic 66 Summarizing

Chapter should have

Justified research approaches and paradigms

Described

Outlines Research design

Research process

Collection and analysis of data

Discussed

Ethics

Validity

Reliability

Explained

Researcher positioning (qualitative research methodology)

Limitations

Topic 67: Methodology: Language Use

Tense:

Writing methodology Chapter involves various tense

Simple past tense for saying what you did for example “Verbal report allowed to access….."

Present tense for defense for example “interviews provide an in-depth……”

Present perfect tense to what others have said “Patton (1990) has suggested that……”

Past perfect/past for reflecting on choices commanding on why example “Data from classroom observation was….”

Topic 68: Important Questions Answer

What is the difference between methods and methodology?

Methodology- theoretical approach or frame work

Methods- the specific method used for data collection

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When should methodology chapter be written?

First draft is often put together when writing research proposal

Detail are added after literature search and after the research process is completed

Then while doing and reviewing pilot study

It is likely to be work for many months

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Topic 69: Result Chapter Functions

Introduction

Focus:

RATTER

Presentation of results/ findings of study and analysis

Some thesis combines results finding and the discussion of the result in one chapter

But mostly they are presented in separate chapters

Difference between findings and analysis to be kept in mind

Accuracy in recording and analysis

Contradictory evidence?

Topic 70: Result Chapter Functions

Key purpose to: (Q. How are result chapters presented)

presenting findings

enable the reader to link between findings with research question

It requires:

Referring back to the material presented in methodology chapter

And point forward to what will be considered in chapter discussion

Presenting Results:

Carefully consider how much explanation is needed

Evidence from data and analysis is feature frequently as you support your findings

Evidence from data and analysis will be link between findings with research question

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Topic 71: Result, Content and Structure

The macro-structure is mostly organize around research question

Some authors present result thematically

mcq • In case of triangulation- all data sources need to be covered

1. Present meta-textual information

Provide back ground information

Reference to methodology

Point forward to discuss

Provide links to sections

Present Results (Q. How are result chapters presented)

Restate research question/hypothesis

Present procedures of result for generating results

Present result

Provide evidence

Explain what each results means

3. Integrate, summarize and conclude

Topic 72 Quantitative Results (M IMP Q. How qualitative results are represeted?)

Clarification of how the results are presented:

- According to research questions
- According to methods
- Both
- Highlight sections

Example

The researcher presents quantitative results from:

- Classroom observation
- Questionnaire Survey

Followed by qualitative results

Re-state the result question and methodology

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Present the results in tables. Graph or pie charts as appropriate

Refer to the tables/ graph to explain

Self-report strongly predict the studied behavior of the worker

Self-report negative predict

Indicate immediate numbers

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Lesson 13

Topic 73: Qualitative Research

Indicate how they are organized and presented:

Highlight sections

Refer to the methodology briefly and research questions

Example:

Response to general questions

Response to stimulated- recorded questions III. Individual questions

IV. Factors affecting WTC behavior in class

Response to general questions:

Using table information in which author provided textual report on each questions

Then he presents a serious of separate findings in response to a questions

Instead of specific frequency, authors use words such as “predominantly”, “generally” etc

Critique:

- Should ideally be presented in themes
- Emerging vertical and horizontal themes
- Thematic headings
- Numbers/ percentages important

Topic 74: Qualitative Responses

Thematic findings

- Findings to be presented thematically as related to each questions
- Heading as themes

Quotes/ verbatim

- Use of verbatim to validate
- Longer quotes to be presented- formatting important
- Interpretation

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Participant profile

Participant profile to be presented in the findings to be relate

Consolidated summary at the end of each section

Percentages/numbers

Topic 75: Key Linguist Features: Tenses

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The tense and voice selections depends on functions of statement being made

Reporting of questions and methodology: past and passive past

Examples

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"This question considers whether learners WTC behavior differed …."

"The question was analyzed using ANOVA……" (passive voice)

Indications

"The means and standard deviation of WTC across three class context are present in table 6.3" (passive present)

Interpretation or explanation: Simple present

The results reveal patterns of deviation

Topic 76: Caution in Presenting Results

There are sometime options in using tense and voice but there must be functional reason for choice

Simple Past/Present Tenses

Examples of its consist use:

Data from interviews revealed/ reveal

Comments from individual participants… suggested/ suggests that…

All participants appeared/appear to be….

Topic 77: Key Linguist Features in Qualitative Research

Qualitative research involve subjective interpretation

Hedging

Definitive Language is avoided

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Buffering of statements

Example:

The results seems to indicate an emergence of pattern

A theme of conflict is discernible here with the use of words

Example

Relatively larger number of….(percentage can come)

It can be argued

Topic 78: Presenting Results visually (M.IMP L.Q Visual Representation of Qualitative Research?)

Guidelines for visual Representation:

Consistency in approach

Weather compares values down a column or across a row

Be selective

Avoid unnecessary detail

Visual appeal and clearly are key considerations

A clear connections between tables, figures and text

Appropriate labeling

Consult most recent style manual for guidelines

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Lesson No. 14

Topic 79: Presenting Qualitative Results

Qualitative Results

- More likely to present words and ideas
- More flexible with the idea

Data need to be

- Summarized
- Categorized
- Coded
- Thematic categorizes to be developed
- Illustrate it in with textual presentations
  - Example with table or figures
  - Direct quotations from transcribed records

Topic 80: Data Display S.Q

- Tables and figures provides information more efficiently
- Make data more understandable

- [redacted]
- [redacted]
- Figures include chart, graphs, photograph, drawing, illustration or any textual depiction

Guidelines on Tables and Figure:

Data display purpose

- Exploration
- Communication
- Calculation
- Storage

Design and preparation

- Decide hierarchy of purpose
- Chose best template for its primary purpose
- Graphical material require careful attention to organization content
- Label
- Use fonts large enough to read

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Use all information needed to understand with graphical image

Keep it freeform extraneous material

Topic 81. Data Display: Formatting and Numbering

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Formatting:

- All elements of manuscript must be in electronic form
- eg, doc, pdf, jpg,
- preparing tables with word-processing programs lowers the probability of typesetting error

Table and Figure Number:

- Use Arabic numerical
- Their order must match with those mentioned in text
- Do not use suffix letters (Table 5, Table 6 instead of 5, 5a, 5b)

Appendix mcq

- If it includes tables and figures, identify elements with capital letters and Arabic numerals
- i.e Table A1, Figure C2

Tables:

Limit the content to essential material

Should be integral to the text but can be understood in isolation

Their layout should be logical and easily grasped by the reader

Compares entries should be next to one another

Different indicates (e.g mean, standard deviation, sample size) should be segregated

Tables are meant to show something specific

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L.Q Topic 82: Discussion of Tables

Discussing Tables in Text:

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An informative tables supplements the text

Refer to the text and tell the reader what to look for

Discuss only table highlights

Citing example; “as shown in table 8...”

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Relation between tables

Combine table that repeats data

Be consistent in the presentation to facilitate comparisons

Table Title

Brief but clear and explanatory

Neither to general nor too detail

Abbreviations used in title may be explained with an asterisk

Topic 83: Principles of Figures Use (IMP)

Consider: (LQ. Explain the principle of figures?)

Informative value

A figure should not be included

It does not add to the understanding of the paper ○ It duplicates other elements

Weather a figure is the best way to communicate the information

These must be able to understood on their own

Label clearly

Can be used effectively to show relationship or hierarchy

Topic 84: Types of Figures (M. IMP L.Q)

Graphs:

Typically indicates comparison between two quantitative indices

Charts:

Display non-quantitative information

Such as flow of subjects through a process

Maps:

Generally display spatial information

Drawings:

Shoe information pictorially

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Photograph:

Direct visual presentation of information

Topic 85: Standard for figures

(LQ. briefly describe the figures?)

Type text here

Basic standard:

Simplicity

Clarity

Continuity

Information value

A good figure:

Augments rather than duplication the text

Convey only essential facts

Omits visually distracting detail

Easily readable

Easily to understand

Is efficient in showing the relationship and comparisons

Is carefully panned and prepared

Be sure that:

Axis and elements within figures are clearly labeled

Sufficient information is given

Symbols are easy to differentiate

Graphs are large enough to be discernible

Topic 86: Important Questions Answered

Do all results from analyzed need to be presented?

Only those contributing to research questions/ hypothesis

Which of the results should be visually represented?

Depends on:

The numbers of statistics

Intention

Complexity of information

How much explanation should accompany tables and figures?

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Text should focus on key observation and patterns

Explanation should be as concise as possible

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Lesson No. 15

Topic 87: Discussion of Results

A separate chapter from the presentation of results and conclusion

Some say combine it with results or conclusion-later not advised

Discussion needs to be divided into meaningful sections and themes

Consider it as single chapter we need to look at its

- purpose
- and functions

Topic 88: Discussion of Results: Functions

Functions:

An overview aims of the research

Summary of theoretical and research context

3. A summary for investigated the research questions

A discussion of perceived contributions of our results

Interpretation

6. Key themes with relevance questions

7. Previous relevance

Topic 89: Discussion Discussion Chapter)

Discussion

Research question(s)

- Positions in the thesis
- Discussion more than the summaries

They should

Discussion can be

Theoretical

General

Integrated with the field

Connected

Connected

And combinations of these

Discussion Moves:

Consolidate your research space (obligatory)

Indicates the implications (optional but common)

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Identifies the area for future research (optional)

Evaluates

Topic 90: Discussion: Content and Structure

Moves and Sub-Moves

Provide back ground information

Restatement of :

- Aims
- Published research
- Approach

Present statement of results

- Restatement of key results

Evaluate/ comment on results or findings

- Explanation of results
- (Un) expected results- comment on whether it was expected or not
- Reference to previous research
- Exemplification- provide example of the results
- Deduction- make a more general claim
- Support from previous research- to support the claim
- Recommendation – for the future research
- Justification of future research- why future research is recommended?

Limitation of the research

Topic 91: Sample Analysis of Discussion Chapter

Introduction to the discussion:

Provide an advance organizer what is to be presented in this chapter

Few Moves Samples:

The first research question investigate relationship between …(move 1a background)

Correlation analysis indicate that self-reported strongly predict ……(move 2a)

The strong positive relationship between self-report … and… showed….. However the participants' behavior in whole class and pair work contradicted what was reported in the questionnaire (move 2b expansion)

Here self-report… seemed to contradict the claim of participant being generally an extroverted and talkative person (move 2d illustration)

Topic 92: Conclusion of Discussion

Conclusion of Discussion

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This sections begins with restatement of what has been discussed

Significance

Study's contribution to existing body of knowledge is highlighted

Examples

This chapter has summarized and consolidated findings of the current study….

Results from this study pointed to a number of factors that participants perceived as being most important….

The findings conform the results or contradict … why

Limitations of the study

Future research here or in the conclusion chapter?

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Topic 93: Discussion Key Linguistic Feature

(LQ) **Discussion Key Linguistic Feature**

While discussing the significance of findings or comparison, one can be very assertive.

- "The results of current study do not support this conclusion"

But at times one needs to be more tentative in claims

If you are presenting possibilities rather than absolutes certainties, you need to hedge in your presentations

- "The findings above seemed to be reveal…"

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Lesson No. 16

Topic 94: Limitation in Discussion

Reporting the Limitations:

Discussions are not about the weakness in research but emphasizing its on strength , implications and interpretations

Reporting Limitations Research Report Scope:

It should be noted that this study has examined only…..

The results of the study have limited generalizability because ….

The limitations of the study are

It would be pertinent to remember that these finding to not imply…

The lack of…. means we cannot be certain

However the findings do not imply

Topic 95: Important Questions Answered

Can I introduce new literature in discussion of the results?

Not advised. If necessary then add in literature review too

How much literature do I need to refer when comparing my results with that refers it in review?

Only the relevant results and aspect needed to explain differences

To what extant do the ideas needs to be based on literature presented in literature review?

Your reasoning must be informed by the literature

Topic 96: Conclusion (IMP L.Q Purpose and structure of conclusion chapter)

Conclusion / L.Q why conclusion are present in writing work?

The conclusion often presented in the separated chapter

But sometimes may be combined with discussion of results

Advice- present as separate chapter

Commonalities with introduction but is more in-depth

Aims or purpose

Significance of the study

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Methodology

Common Elements

Results

Interpretations-comparison with discussion

Implications

Limitation

Future research

Contribution of the study

Topic 97: Conclusion of a Thesis Functions (L.Q Functions of conclusion chapter)

Functions:

1. A reminder methodological features of your research
2. Summary of
3. Evaluation of the study's with commentary on
   - Its contribution
   - Limit
   - and methods

Practical implications

Recommendations

Topic 98: Conclusion:

Moves and Sub-moves:

1. Restatements

Stating aims

Stating key features of methodology and method

Summary of findings

Summary of key findings

Evaluation of the study's significance contributions

Significance to findings for theory and research development

Significance for practical applications

Justification

Identification on any limitations

Recommendations

Recommendations for future research

Topic 99: Introduction in the conclusion chapter

Introduction

An advance organizer

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Sample

This chapter presents, firstly, a summary of the key findings of the research, followed by the consideration a consideration of the pedagogical implications for teacher and institutions as well as recommendation for future research.

Gives a very clear listing of the area that will be included

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Topic 100: Summarizing key Findings

Sample text

"The primary objective of this study was to investigate…" (Move 1a aims)

The study was carried out at a university language center in Auckland… a triangulation approach was adopted (move 1b method)

"… this study investigated factors that influences willingness…" (Move 3a significance)

"Although data analysis indicated some relationship but could not be generalized beyond…." (Move 3b limitations)

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Sample Analysis

Very clear and logical summarization

Offer more than a list of summarized items

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Lesson No 17

Topic 101: Implications

Sample Text

"The results of the present study have confirmed that WTC is a factor that must be recognized as important in second language instructions." (Move 3a, significance)

"The teacher could help ensure that L2 communication needs of the students are accommodated."

"It is believed that group activities have the potential to increase the learning since students help one another……, thus leading to language development."

Topic 102: Implications for Future Research

Sample Text

"The results have provided evidence that WTC is useful construct in accounting for L2 communications" (Move 2, finding)

"This study has identified a number of factors that….. future research could examine in further detail." (Move 4a, further research)

Another has introduce at least one new recommendation in each paragraph

Recommendation are accompanied by findings, a limitations, a justifications or significance

Topic 103: Limitations

Limitations can be:

Methodological

Contextual

Pragmatic

Sample Text:

"The most obvious limitation in study was that of a small sample size…" (Move 3d, limitations)

"Still the small population did not negate recognition of the importance of WTC in learning" (move 3a Significance)

Limitation can be presented before the recommendations

Topic 104: Concluded Paragraph

Final selection of conclusion:

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Read very much like abstract

Has Lenoir and logical presentation

Text of Conclusion (examples)

"The primary purpose of the study was" (Move 1a, aims)

"Eight students enrolled……. Participated in this study … multiple instruments…. were used" (Move 1b, method)

The most useful finding……. (Move 2, finding)

Results from this investigation….pointed to pedagogical implications….. (Move 3, significance)

Increased awareness may be expected to leads practical steps….. (Move 3b, justification)

"Further research was suggested to look at the... Proficiency level…" (Move 4a, further research)

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Topic 105: Conclusion: Key Linguistic Features

(L.Q) **Modal verb**

- Recommendation for applications and further research tends to be use:
- Frequent use of modal 'should' rather than weaker modal choice 'could' or 'May'

Examples

"The findings should be seen……"

- "The teacher should be informed that……"
- "The teacher should create suitable interaction opportunities …"
- "The techniques should engage students in class discussion…."

Subordination

- Subordinates clause are often used while presenting limitations
- Such as
  - Clouse of concession
- Example

"Although WTC was found to change over the one-month period in this study, time span was not long enough to document a systematic change in WTC classroom behavior."

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Topic 106: Important Questions Answered

IMP L.Q **Q: 1 What is the difference between summary and conclusion?**

Conclusion is the statement about:

- The importance
- Significance
- contribution of your findings

Summary is:

- mere summing up

Q.2 Does the conclusion present any new information?

No- but expands certain points

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Lesson No 18

Topic 107: Confidentiality

Researcher should never disclose:

- Personally identifiable information of the participants

Protecting confidentiality:

- Obtaining written consent
- Disguising some aspect

L.Q

Disguising strategies:

- Altering specific characteristics e.g. names
- Limiting description of specific characteristics
- Using composites

Topic 108: Writing Clearly and Concisely (IMP L.Q Guidelines for writing clearly and concisely)

Organizing:

Consider the best length and structure of your findings

- Logical ordering strengthens the impact of writing

Length:

Rule: “less is more”

- Discursive writing often obscures author’s main point
- State points clearly and directly
- Eliminate repetitions

Organizing Manuscript with Headings:

- Organizational structure is key to clear, precise and logical communication
- This includes the use of headings to effectively organize the ideas

Topic 109: Headings

Concise headings

Inform key point

Track the development of arguments

Level of headings establish the hierarchy of sections

Use at least two subsections headings within any sections

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L.Q **Levels of Headings**

APA suggest formatting arrangement for different headings levels:

Centered, Boldface, Uppercase and Lowercase Headings

Flush Left, Boldface, Uppercase and Lowercase Headings

Indented, boldface, lowercase paragraph headings endings with a period

Indented, boldface, italicized lowercase paragraph headings endings with a period

Indented, italicized lowercase paragraph headings endings with a period

Topic 110: Numbering

Seriation helps the reader understand the organization of key points

Separation points are identifies with Arabic numerals, followed by period, written in sentence format

Example

Individuals who ….

(Paragraph continues)

Non depressed persons exposed to …..

(Paragraph continuous)

Depress person exposed to…..

(Paragraph continues)

The use of bullets instead of "numbered lists" helps eliminate risk of unwanted original position, e.g.

Individuals who ….

Paragraph continues)

Non …..

(Paragraph continuous)

Depress person exposed to…..

Topic 111:

Prime objective of

Clear communication

Clarity can be achieved through:

Presenting ideas orderly

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And expressly oneself smoothly and concisely

Establishing an effective tone also:

Engages

Communicate ideas clearly

Topic 112: Writing Style: Continuity

Continuity in Presenting Ideas Includes:

Continuity

Continuity

Thematic development from opening statement to the conclusion

Achieving Continuity:

Punctuation marks

-
- Contributes

Neit
her between ideas

Use it to support meaning

Transitional words

Help maintain

Especially when and abstract ○

Use f pronoun

- Times links:
- Cause effect
- Additional
- Contrast links: but, conversely, never the less, however, although

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Lesson No. 19

Topic 113: Smoothness of Expression

Try to be clear and logical

- Ambiguity sudden shift to topic, tense or person, inserting the unexpected; omitting the expected can confuse or disturb the readers
- Peer review can help indicates the contradictions
- Reading the paper aloud also help

L.Q **Noun Strings:**

Several noun used one after another also create abruptness

- Skill full hyphenation can address it
- Best approach is to untangle the string

Untangling Example:

"Commonly used investigative explanation issue control question technique"

A control question-technique that is commonly used to expand issues in investigation

- An expanded-issues control- question that is commonly used in investigations
- A common technique to using control questions to investigate expanded questions

Topic 114: Tone

Writings tone does not need to be dull

Present ideas and finding directly

But

Aims for interesting and compelling style

Tone must reflect your involvement

Difference should be presented in a professional, non-combative manner
Example

“Fong and Nissber did not address....” is acceptable,

Whereas “Fong and Nissber completely overlooked…” is not.

An effective technique:

Imagine a specific reader

Indent to educate and persuade that individual

Envisioning a familiar person will make it effective

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Topic 115: Economy of Expression

Say only what is need to be said

Eliminate:

Redundancy

Wordiness

Jargon

Evasiveness

Overuse of passive

Circumlocution

Clumsy pose

Wordiness

Can be impede the ready grasp the ideas

Short words and short sentences are easier to comprehend

Redundancy

Use no more words tan necessary to convey the meaning

The total of 68 participants

Absolutely essential

Small in size

Unit length

Varied sentence length maintained interest

Similar caution applies to paragraph length, neither too lengthy nor too short

Topic 116: Precision and Clarity

Word Choice

Make sure to use the word that convey exact meanings

Informal words are not accepted

Colloquial Expressions

Avoid them

The diffuse meanings

Approximation weakness statement and is interpreted differently

Avoid jargon

Pronoun confuse readers unless referent for each pronoun is obvious

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Refrain from ambiguity or illogical comparisons

Topic 117: Linguistic Devices

Devices that attract attention to words or sound

Instead of ideas

These are in appropriate

Avoid heavy illation, rhyming, poetic expressions and clichés

Avoid:

- Mix metaphor
- Words with surplus

Don't use figurative expression

Topic 118: Strategies to Improve Writing Style

The fit between the author and strategy is more important than a particular strategy used

Approaches to Effective Communication:

Writing from outline

Putting aside the first draft, re-read later

Asking a colleague to review and critique the draft

Thinking of audience and purpose

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Lesson No. 20

Topic 119: Appropriate level of specificity

Precision:

Essential in scientific writing

Choose accurate words

Clear and free from bias

The appropriate degree of specificity depends on:

The research question

Present state of knowledge in the field of study

To describe age group:

Give specific age range

Instead of broad category (over 65 year) Be careful in describing racial or ethnic groups

L.Q **Topic 120: Reducing Bias in Language**

When describing racial and ethnic groups appropriately

Be specific

Sensitive to issue of labeling

- Describe people by their nation or region of origin
- Chinese Americans, Africans Americans

Be Sensitive to Labels

Avoid labeling

- Respect peoples preferences
- Call them what they prefer to be called
- Accept the prefer change with the time and individual within the group

Topic 121: Acknowledge Participation

Write about the people in that way acknowledge participate

Use descriptive terms such as respondents, participate, college students etc..

Passive Voice

It is suggested that people are acted upon instead of beings actors

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Thus "the students completed the survey" is preferable or "the student were given the survey"

Avoid term failed "the participants failed to complete…"

It can imply the personal shortcoming instead of results research

Did not is more neutral choice

(L.Q) **Topic 122: Reducing Bias: Gender**

Gender

Refer to role not biological sex

It is cultural

Avoid ambiguity in sex identity or gender role

Sexist bias Can occur when pronoun are used carelessly ○ As he is used to refer to both sexes

○ Or pronoun is used to exclusively to define roles by sex
○ The use of man as a generic noun

○ Or as ending for an occupational tile ○ Police man instead of police officers ○ Use alternatives to generic he

○ Combining forms such as he/ she or (s) he are awkward and distracting
○ Avoid referring as opposite sex

○ Appropriate wording: the other sex

Topic 123: Reducing Bias: Ethnicity

Preferences for term referring to racial or ethnicity change group often

Use commonly accepted designations

Blacks and African are currently acceptable but Negro American is not acceptable

Use more specific terms

Language that essentializes or reifies race is strongly discourage

Word should minority should also be used with modifier (such as ethnic or racial)

Indigenous Group:

You use broader terms

Like native American, first nations

Term Asian or Asian American is preferred to oriental

Better to specify names of subgroups: Pakistani, Chinese etc

Topic 124: Reducing Bias: Disabilities and Age

Disabilities L.Q Bias in disabilities

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Maintain the

Or that use pictorial metaphor (wheelchair bound)

Avoid language that:

Use excessive

- Can be

Use people first language (people with intellectual disabilities)

Age: (L.Q Guidelines mentioning age in Research Thesis)

- Should be description

Be specific

Avoid open

Terms young

Terms as elderly or senior are not acceptable as noun

Age groups may be describe as adjectives

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Lesson No. 21

Topic 125: Grammar and Usage

Incorrect grammar and careless sentences construction distract the reader

Incorrect grammar introduce ambiguity

And generally obstruct communication

Let us review some frequently grammatical and usage problems in manuscript

Topic 126: Subject Verb Agreement

Verb must agree in number with it subject

Correct:

The percentage of correct responses as well as the speed of responses **increases** with practice

Incorrect:

The percentage of correct responses as well as the speed of responses **increase** with practice

The plural of noun that may be singular need attention

Correct:

The data **were** collected

Incorrect:

The data **was** collected

Correct:

These phenomena **occur** every 100 years

Incorrect:

The phenomena

Topic 127: Crediting for Direct Quotes)

Quoting

Reproducing word by word material directly in quoted form: ○
Another authors work

○ Your own previously published work

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Writing for Research

- Always

Incorporate

Use quotation
Must fit in

- Must be
-
  Longer from the main text

Smaller

Indented followed by citation

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Topic 128: Paraphrasing and Quoting

Direct quoting and online material without pagination

Quoting and paraphrasing require or paragraph number

If sources do not provide page number, use given paragraph number

Accuracy

Follow wording, spelling, interior, punctuation, even source is incorrect

If any incorrect spelling or grammar might confuse the reader, insert [sic] immediately after error

Use […] to indicate omitted material

To emphasized a word, italicize and immediately after it [emphasize added]

Quoting more than 800 words require written permission from the owner of copyrighted work

Paraphrasing require staying close to meaning

If the meanings is being adapted then a footnote must follow

Topic 129: Citations in the Text

Requires References:

With author date citation system

Listed alphabetically references list

To be identical in spellings at both places

Exception: classical works [Bible, Qur'an] will be cited only in the text

One Work by one Another

Surname (suffixes not required)

Year of publication

Examples:

Kessler (2003) found that….

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Early onset result in a more persistent and severe course (klesser, 2003)

One Work by Multiple Authors

Kisangau, Lyaruu, Hossh and Josph (2007) found….

Kisangau et al. (2007)

Ibid. use

Topic 130: References

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References Why?

Acknowledge the work of previous scholars

Provide a reliable way to locate it

Validate arguments

References List

Start on a new page

The word references should appear in uppercase and lower case letters, centered.

Double space all entries

Use hanging indent format

Footnotes

Supplement or amplify

Should not include irrelevant information

Include copyright permission for lengthy quotes

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Lesson No. 22

Topic 131: Mechanics of Style: Punctuation-Period

Punctuation:

Establishes the cadences of a sentence

Telling where to pause, stop or take detour

Denotes a pause in thoughts

Period:

Use to end a complete sentence

With a abbreviations, as in U.S. Navy

In initials of names (J. M. Smith)

Reference abbreviations (Vol. 1. 2nd

Do not use period with:

Abbreviations of state names (NY, OH)

Capital letter abbreviation (APA, IQ)

Web addresses (http://www.apa.org)

Metric and non-metric measurement abbreviations 9 (cm ft, hr, kg, min, ml)

Exceptions:

Abbreviations for inch (in.) takes period

L.Q **Topic 132: Capitalization**

Uppercase letter for the first letter of the word

- The first word in complete sentence
- The first word after the colon that begins a complete sentence
- Major words in the title and heading (Example: In her book, History of Pathology)
- Major words in article headings and subheadings
- Exception: level 3,4,5 headings
- Proper nouns
- Nouns followed by numerals and or letter
- Titles of test
- Names of factors, variables and effect

Topic 133: Numbers

Use words to express numbers below 10

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Use numerals for number above 10 in the abstract or graphical display that precede a unit of measurement

- Statistical or mathematical function
- Times, date, age
- Scores and points on scale
- Exact sum of money
- Numbers that denotes a specific place in numbered series

L.Q **Numbers express in words**

Any numbers that begins a sentences title or text headings

- Common Fraction
- Use combinations to express back to back modification i.e. 2 two way interaction ten 7 point scale
- If readability suffers, spell out both

Topic 134: Punctuation: Quotation Marks

Use double Quotation Marks

To introduce a word or phrase as an ironic comments e.g. Considered “normal” behavior

To set off the article or chapter title when mentioned in text

To reproduce material from a test or verbatim instruction to participants

Don’t use double quotations marks, italicize instead

To identify the anchors of a scale

To cite letter, word, phrase or sentences as a linguistic example

Topic 135: Latin Abbreviations

Latin Terms:

Add technical precision

Latin phrases have strong influence on academic English

Latin Abbreviations

e.g. (*exempli gratia*)

i.e. (*id est: that is*)

N.B. (*note bene: take note)*

Few Abbreviation Derive From Latin

A.M. / P.M.

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Ibid. (*ibidem*)

etc. (*et cetera*)

et al. (*et alii: and others*)

Topic 136: Academic Writing: Some Other Considerations

Considerations

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Audience

↓

Purpose

↓

Organization

↓

Style

↓

Flow

↓

Presentation

Purpose & Strategy

Audience, purpose and strategy are interconnected

Instructional for audiences who knows less

Displaying familiarity, expertise and intelligence

Organization

Use a structure format

Take advantage of regular, predictable patterns of organization

It helps reader follow even if you make error

Style flow and Presentation

Will be guided by purpose and audience

Use signposting

Reminders

Ensure clarity in presentation

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Lesson No.23

Topic 137: Academic Style: Formal Language

Nouns & Other Parts of Speech

There may be more than one way to express an idea

Strive to choose the most precise and formal words

Formal Grammar & Style

Formal Grammar & Style

1. Avoid Contractions

i.e. will not instead of *won't*

Use more appropriate formal negative forms

- not …any no
- not …much little
- not …many few

Limit the use of "run on" expressions ○

i.e. "and so forth"

- and "etc."

Avoid addressing the reader as “you”

Limit use of direct questions

Place adverb with the verb where clarity is required

Topic 138: Writing Process

Writing Process

Set a realistic pace

Recognize your progress by setting goals and acknowledge the effort

Arithmetic of Writing

How will you measure your written output?

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How will you identify the pace of writing that suits you?

How will you establish momentum in your writing?

Consider range of strategies

Thesis requires the writer to experiment with new techniques

Keep a focus on what you are thinking

Three Principles:

Learning comes through writing

Quality comes through revising

Regular writing leads to fluency

Topic 139: Principles of Academic Writing

Helpful Questions

What are the conventions of writing in this discipline?

What language – noun, verbs, links, etc. – do writers use?

How are debates presented?

How is the researcher represented, if at all?

How is structure revealed?

What are the options in style and structure?

Topic 140: Analyzing a Thesis

Scan the table of contents:

What type of structure is used?

Experimental/narrative/other form of logical progression?

What are the approximate relative lengths of chapters?

Is this structure reflected in the abstract?

Read the introductory paragraphs of each chapter.

How is progression made from chapter to chapter?

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What are the main differences between chapters?

Look at structure and style: long/short sentences and paragraphs.

Look at language used: what are the key words?

Types of verbs used

Topic 141: Goal Setting

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Be SMART Effective goals are:

Specific

Measurable

Achievable

Realistic

Timed

SMART Version 2

Simple: understandable

Meaningful: to you, aligned with your core values

As if now: real to you

Responsible: for everyone involved

Towards what you want: not someone else's goal

Writing Goals

Define the purpose of writing task

Choose a writing verb

Define your audience

Define the scale and scope of your writing

Decide how long you will take to write it

Declare when

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Topic 142: Defining the Writing Task

Making Checklist

Provides a route map on a long complex journey

makes it all manageable

clarifies what needs to be done

Start writing now

Discuss writing explicitly with your supervisor.

Read one book on writing in your discipline.

Make up a rough timetable for writing

Set long- and short-term writing goals.

Find about punctuation rules and grammar.

Define audience and purpose for your writing.

Discuss all these points with your supervisor.

Consider taking a workshop

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Lesson No. 24

Topic 143: Writing Purpose

What purpose will writing serve for you?

You are writing to learn.

You are writing to explore your research topic.

You are writing to report.

You are writing to persuade.

Topic 144: How will my thesis be assessed?

The external examiner will scrutinize:

Review of the literature

Design of the study

Presentation of results

Discussion and conclusion

Review of Literature

Relevance to the research study?

Has the candidate slipped into ‘here is all I know about x’?

Evidence of critical appraisal?

Explicit links between the review and design of study?

Gap?

Rationale for research focus, design and method?

Research questions answered?

Coherence

Topic 145: Assessment of Thesis Design

Design of Study

Were the research questions answered?

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Assessment of Thesis Design

What precautions were taken against likely sources of bias?

What are the limitations of the design?

Is the candidate aware of them?

Has candidate given an adequate justification for the design used?

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Topic 146: Tackling Issues

What can I write about the design of the study?

Precautions against bias?

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I am most likely to be biased in . . .

I am least likely to be biased in . . .

Bias would reveal itself as . . .

Would be reflected in …

I will limit the design in order to make it feasible by . . .

This is a positive choice – rather than weakness – because . . .

I can justify the design I am using/going to use by . . .

Topic 147: Defining Originality

Checklist:

Saying something never said before

You do the empirical work no one has done so far

You synthesize things that were not put together before

New interpretation of material/ideas.

New to context

You take an existing technique and apply it to a new area

Working across disciplines, using different methodologies

Focusing on topics that people in your discipline has not looked at

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You test an existing knowledge in an original way

You add to the knowledge in a way that has not been done before

You write down a new piece of information for the first time

Topic 148: Keeping Back-ups

Data safety

Make a second set of back-up disk/ memory stick

Put each chapter on a separate disk/ memory stick

Put your bibliography on a separate disk/ memory stick

Keep them in a different building from your other set or on a server

When going on holidays/ to a conference, take a set of back-ups with you and leave a set with a friend

Update your backups EVERY DAY

Printout hard copy after all major revisions

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Lesson No. 25

Topic 149: Reasons for Not Writing: Peer Support

Reasons for Not Writing

Numerous reasons stated by people

Displacement activity

One Good Reason: Taking a Break.

People may prefer to do field work first,

Putting off writing till later

Don't know what to write or how?

Peer Support

Discussion with peers:

helps develop understanding of what you are getting into,

and how to get through it.

Supports when the task seems impossible

Topic 150: Discussing Feedback

Discussing Feedback

A way of enhancing communication

It has to be a genuine dialogue

Points to Consider:

What feedback has been provided on your writing?

When was this discussed/agreed?

Was it explicit?

Do different comments require different types of revisions?

Have the links been discussed clearly?

Does your supervisor have a method of signaling them?

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When will this subject be reviewed (in future discussions)?

Topic 151: Free Writing

What is Free Writing?

Writing for five minutes without stopping

In sentences

Private writing: no external reader

Topic: what is worrying you

No structure needed

Topic 152: Benefits of Free Writing

Benefits of Free Writing

An experience of 'personal success' associated with writing

Stepping back to see the project as a whole

Frees up the thinking process

Surfacing of deep thoughts

It gives value to emotions and feelings

Increases confidence

Increases optimism about the study

L.Q

Topic 153: Generative Writing

Key Points:

Write for five minutes

- Without stopping
- In sentences
- Stick to one topic, possibly something from your free writing
- Let someone read it

Difference from Free writing

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More closed

Awareness of the audience

Responsibility to make sense

Topic 154: Writing to Prompts

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Writing to prompts

What have I written and what would I like to do?

Where do my ideas come from?

How does what I read compare with my own views?

What I want to write about next is . . .

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Lesson No. 25

Topic 155: Other Problems in Writing

Other Problems in Writing

Fear of supervisor

Fear of feedback,

Fatigue

Boredom, often a sign of stress

Lack of momentum

Not writing often enough

Fear of the big picture: failure

Lack of rewards

Difficulty in signaling problems

Not achieving high standard in writing

Topic 156: Writers Block

What is it?

Block moments: when we cannot produce writing

It may occur at particular points

Most Often:

used term

feared

difficult to resolve

Why ?

They think they must work out what they think – and what they want to say before they can write . . . and get stuck at that point

They want to be sure before they write . . . instead of when they are not sure

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There is no end to the project in sight

Topic 157: Resolving Issues

Strategies for Unblocking

Free writing

Generative writing

Discussing writing with supervisor

Mind-mapping

Verbal rehearsal

'Write down all you know about ..

'Write down all your ideas on …

Construct a sense of an ending

visualize the completed thesis

Preventive Strategies

Become addicted to writing

Finish today's writing session by defining tomorrow's

Write before everything else

Don’t worry writing.

Gather together all the writing you’ve done and notice how much there is.

Topic 158: Scaffolding an Argument

Steps for Scaffolding

Decide on the main point

Define terms

Elaborate your point

Discuss examples or evidence

Paragraph Structure

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Topic sentence

Elaborate

Say how your example makes the point in your topic

Conclude or signpost the next paragraph

Topic 159: Positioning of Self

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Important in qualitative research

Objectivity not possible

Purpose:

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To disclose:

Possible influence on data collection-responses

Possible researcher bias in interpretation

Gender

Age

Ethnicity

Religion

Discuss strategies to minimize the effect of self

Awareness of the issue

Topic 160: Writing a Case Study

Examine the case thoroughly

Take notes

Highlight relevant facts

Underline key problems

Focus your analysis

Identify the key problems

Why do they exist?

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How do they impact the organization?

Who is responsible for them?

Uncover possible solutions

Review readings, discussions

5. Read case studies for samples before writing your own

6. Thick descriptions

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Highlighted Handout By PIN ✌ and MUHAMMAD

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